

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday Feb 18, 2021

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #43, Feb 18, 2021

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:04 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (9/11): Francesco Cesarini, Maxim Fedorov, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Kenneth Lundin, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, José Valim, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman. Bryan Paxton was also present

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #42 held on Feb 4, 2020. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions: preparations have been made for Nayra onboarding (starts Monday Feb 22)
3. No financial update (nothing out of the ordinary to report, Sebastian has been busy closing the books for last year). Membership report: Annual Supporting members: 100 (+1), Lifetime Supporting members: 11 (unchanged), Basic members: 548 (+11).
4. Sponsorship WG update: no meeting last week, the group is still working on a presentation. Some outreach has begun. If you know your company is ready to receive an invoice for 2021 sponsorship, please reach out to Sebastian. (Some companies have already indicated ready for invoice: Erlang Solutions, Peer Stritzinger, Ericsson, Klarna(?), and Dashbit - Sebastian to invoice them).
5. Upcoming board elections: Fred presented the proposal he has communicated to the board via email, see attachment for details, the proposed schedule is as follows:
 - February 26 (Last Friday of February): Elections announced, people can submit their candidacy

- March 11 (Thursday 1 week later): Last day to submit your candidacy. Email acceptance ends at midnight PT on the 12th
- March 12 (Friday after opening): Votes are open
- March 19 (1 week later): Votes are closed

Peer will set up the voting using Wild Apricot (and document the procedure for future elections). Francesco suggested creating marketing material templates (that can be reused in coming years). That kind of material could perhaps be done by Nayra, but the schedule is a bit tight to make it in time for this years election. See section 8.1 for board vote on the proposed schedule.

6. Stipend requests:

1. Peer presented the request to support the ROSIE project (Robot Operating System In Erlang) from Walter Cazzola and Natalia Chechina. The request is for \$10,000 and Peer will sherpa. The proposal has gone through the Embedded Working Group, which fully backs the proposal. It is a research project that will be carried out by a student at Milan University as part of the MSc individual project. The funding will go to towards funding equipment to support the research. Application attached. See section 8.2 for board vote on the proposed schedule.
 2. SQLite Ecto Library - this stipend request was withdrawn before the board meeting. The requestor, Lars Wikman, has joined the embedded working group and will refine his request through the WG.
7. José presented the proposed merger of the Build and Packaging WG with the Documentation WG. As the Documentation has reached its main goal of adoption of EEP-48, the remaining work is tooling integration, which can be completed under the umbrella of the Build and Packaging WG. The Build and Packaging WG has agreed to incorporate the Documentation WG, and all members in both working groups agree with this proposal. See section 8.3 for board vote on the proposal.

8. Unanimous Consent Vote:

1. Proposed to adopt the schedule for elections to the EEF board as prepared by Fred.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the elections schedule as proposed by Fred. Unanimously approved.

2. ROSIE stipend request.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the stipend request for \$10,000 to support the ROSIE project as requested in the stipend application. Unanimously approved.

3. Proposal to incorporate the Documentation WG into the Build and Packaging working group.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve that the Documentation WG is subsumed under the Build and Packaging WG. Unanimously approved.

9. Any other questions:

1. José presented the motivation behind the machine learning working group, (see blogpost from yesterday regarding the NX project (Numerical Elixir) here: <https://dashbit.co/blog/nx-numerical-elixir-is-now-publicly-available>).

The plan is to submit a formal request to form a new Machine Learning Working Group (and in the future to request funding for this working group). José further announced his intention to resign from the EEF board (to be able to spend time on these projects without having a conflict of interest).

10. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 16:49 UTC.

Dated Feb 18, 2021

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Attachments:

1. Elections Schedule proposal from Fred Hebert (1 page)
2. Stipend request regarding ROSIE project from Walter Cazzola (2 pages)

From: **Fred Hebert** mononcq@ferd.ca
Subject: [EEF-Board] Elections Schedule
Date: February 15, 2021 at 16:28
To: board@erlef.org, EEF-Board eef-board@googlegroups.com

FH

Alright everyone, sorry for the delays, been thinking things over and also got busy.

So I'm submitting this here timeline for the elections. It is the same as what I had initially proposed, any difference is because I lost the file and re-built it from its initial approach:

- February 26 (Last Friday of February): Elections announced, people can submit their candidacy
- March 11 (Thursday 1 week later): Last day to submit your candidacy. Email acceptance ends at midnight PT on the 12th
- March 12 (Friday after opening): Votes are open
- March 19 (1 week later): Votes are closed

Winners are announced within the week or as early as possible. Last year we expanded the vote-closing week due to Covid. We should keep this flexibility available, but not aim to need it.

The current cohort is cohort B, to be re-elected in 2021, 2024, and every three years after:

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- Peer Stritzinger
- Maxim Fedorov
- Benoit Chesneau
- Miriam Pena

I will prepare a page such as <https://erlef.org/blog/eef/election-2020> for 2021, and the four of you (if you plan on running) should prepare a profile similar to what is on last year's page linked earlier in this sentence.

I'll recruit Peer to set up the poll again this year since he knows the mechanism; I would ask him to also write the steps down as he sets it up in case he does not run or does not get re-elected, and we can make a private foundation repo with the steps in there. I'll also add in last year's script and the schedule structure for future years so we don't re-structure this every year and keep things stable.

I'll recruit whoever from marketing to tweet the initial announcement with dates, and possibly to tweet every time we add a new candidate to the page for the election.

If the volume is judged acceptable, having emails to users announcing: 1. the whole schedule and mechanism, 2. the vote opening (the poll automatically sends an email), 3. the results is something the marketing WG and myself should probably sync on as well.

To note, this makes the candidacy closing time fall into the conference Francesco had brought up. I don't know where or when having a talk about the election makes the most sense at the conference but I suggest:

1. Using a flat strict structure (last friday of Feb, then 1 week increments) and turning that into a predictable pattern for the future
2. not tying the elections logistics to specific commercial events that may require paying to attend or to be in specific time zones
3. allowing people to register independently and the foundation maintaining the official list and profiles on its websites to avoid any accusation of conflicts of interests.
4. Still being able to use the conference as a venue to discuss stuff for people who have submitted their candidacy already and being public that this is planned as a thing the conference offers the foundation. Visibility is good. The conference may impose whichever criteria it wants for its logistics ("must have candidacy submitted 2 days prior to talk", for example), and we should be okay to sync marketing comms with these requirements.

I'm open to any further ideas, but this is the procedure I suggest this time around.

Regards,
Fred.

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Stipend Request

* Stipend Type

Development Work

Develop an OTP-based or a BEAM language-based open source program or library

* First name

Walter

* Last name

Cazzola

Nickname

Nickname

* Email address

cazzola@di.unimi.it

* Phone number

0039 02 503 16300

Organisation name

University of Milan

* City

Milan

Region

Region

* Postal code

20133

* Country

Italy

Twitter handle

w_cazzola

LinkedIn

LinkedIn

WebSite

<https://cazzola.di.unimi.it/>

* **Intended product of the project** (in a couple of sentences, please, explain what you want to produce by the end of the project)

We aim to develop a communication protocol to replace RO2 communication (DDS) with Erlang.

* **Purpose of this project** (in a paragraph or two, please, explain **why** you want to conduct this project and **who** will benefit from it)

ROS and its more scalable 2nd version ROS2 are the most widely used robotics middleware in the world. Both are open source and are extensively used in academia and industry for research, proof of concept, and in commercial robots. Both versions of the middleware are modular where nodes communicate with each other via various communication protocols: ROS uses TCPROS and UDPROS, while ROS2 uses DDS. However, neither ROS nor ROS2 is scalable and their communication is unreliable. The idea is to address the issue by replacing DDS in ROS2 with an Erlang communication protocol. The proposed work is one of the initial steps in that direction. The potential benefits have been previously explored in the following paper:
<http://www.dcs.gla.ac.uk/research/rosie/towards-reliable-and-scalable-robot-communication.pdf>

Lutac, A., Chechina, N., Aragon-Camarasa, G. and Trinder, P., 2016, September. Towards reliable and scalable robot communication. In Proceedings of the 15th International Workshop on Erlang (pp. 12-23).

Robotics community will benefit from scalable and reliable Erlang communication. Erlang community will benefit from exposure to the huge ROS community and further promotion of Erlang in embedded technologies. This project also aims to foster collaboration with an academic Group that works with, and teaches, Erlang and Embedded Systems.

*** Development plan** (in a couple of paragraphs, please, explain who will do the job and for how long, what development stages you envision)

This work will be conducted by a student at Milan University, Italy as part of their MSc individual project. It is expected the work will take 12 months. The development stages will include the following:

1. Exploring existing alternatives to DDS communication protocol for ROS2 to establish the state of the art and the best practices.
2. Design of an Erlang communication protocol.
3. Developing a prototype (or a proof of concept). The aim is to develop a protocol; however, due to the work containing a research element, we may encounter unforeseen complications that may take more time than it is currently anticipated.

*** Dissemination** (please, explain how you intend to inform the public about the project results, e.g. blog posts, conference talks, papers)

Results of the work will be published as a research publication (e.g. a conference paper) and a blog post. We also intend to present the results at industrial conferences, e.g. ROS Industrial <https://rosindustrial.org/rosindustrial-conference-2020>

*** Delivery** (please, explain how you intend to deliver the project results)

Open source git-hub repo (Apache 2 License)

Optional File attachment(s): Maximum upload size in total limited to 8MB

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Choose file	No file chosen

*** Amount (USD)**

\$ 10,000.00

Preferred payment method

We can do checks only within the US. If the request is for \$500 or less, PayPal is suggested.

Submit